



MONTHLY UPDATE

Madagascar: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 • 26 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • TECHNOLOGY • CAPACITY • INCLUSION • DATA

Summary of the month

The first phase of biometric enrolment closed with [more than six million adults registered against a two-million target](#), and the day after that was reported the electoral commission [opened a full reconstitution of the electoral roll, gated on presentation of a national identity card](#).

The Council of Ministers of 8 July did two things on the same day: it [adopted a bill overhauling the 2014 cyber law](#) and it [ordered internet service providers to block pornographic sites, with no timetable, mechanism, named regulator or appeal route](#).

The national police [opened a public reporting platform for violence and disappearances on 28 July](#) with no data controller, retention rule or supervisory authority named, and MVola's new director general [gave the first account of the platform migration that broke the country's dominant payment rail](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

On 20 July the [Technical Assistance Facility for the Refondation](#) was launched at the Palais d'État d'Iavoloha, requested by the presidency and supported by UNDP, running 2026 to 2030, explicitly including the use of digital tools. Administrations had until end-July to submit proposals [through a dedicated digital platform](#); a steering committee screens them and selected interventions run three to nine months. 170 focal points were certified in advance.

Legislation and regulation

The Council of Ministers of 8 July 2026 [adopted a bill overhauling the 2014 cyber law](#) on three axes: protecting the vulnerable, ending digital impunity through revised electronic evidence, connection-data retention and suspect-asset freezing, and mandatory cooperation with justice by telecommunications, internet and digital-finance operators. The framework was previewed at the [first national cybersecurity symposium in June](#), which defined security incidents and critical infrastructure organisations. The bill is not enacted.

The same Council [ordered internet service providers to block pornographic sites](#) on public-order grounds, the executive holding that such content favours the resurgence of delinquency and degrades the security climate. Ministries and public bodies are told to implement it. It is a cabinet decision, not a law, and no timetable, technical mechanism, named regulator or appeal route is specified. It follows a May 2026 ministerial warning and a 15 June announcement of a dedicated social-media law covering harassment, defamation and disinformation.

Regional collaboration

Madagascar attached itself to three external arrangements in twelve days, none of which it wrote. The Council of Ministers [approved joining a China-initiated international network against cybercrime on 4 August](#), mobilising the foreign affairs, justice, public-security, digital-development and gendarmerie ministries for cross-border cooperation on online fraud; no founding text, membership list, data-sharing rule or safeguard on what is exchanged is held. Around 15 August it also [signed the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime and joined the World AI Cooperation Organization](#), the account citing Interpol findings that artificial-intelligence-enabled fraud is outpacing African states' response capacity. An [editorial the same week](#) frames the turn toward Beijing on fraud as inseparable from the country's digital-transformation and investment ambitions. None of the three is evidenced by an instrument the base holds, and the country still has no national artificial-intelligence strategy of its own.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

On 11 July 2026 SpaceX ran [Madagascar's first Direct-to-Cell satellite trial at Sadabe](#), on Airtel's spectrum and following an [FCC notice filed on 13 May](#) — the third African country after Kenya and Uganda. Commercial launch is pending the national regulator.

On 23 July Yas Madagascar [ran a 5G-Advanced trial with Huawei at its Andraharo campus](#), pitching the network as a substrate for artificial intelligence, augmented reality and connected devices. The operator claims to be the fourth in the world to test the technology; the claim is its own. The posts and digital development minister attended and tied it to public-service delivery, learning, health and enterprise access. No commercial 5G service is on record.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

On 27 July the interior ministry reviewed the first phase of adult biometric registration, reporting [more than six million people enrolled against a two-million target across April to June 2026](#). A second phase is in preparation, supported by the World Bank-financed DECIM project. No cost figure for either phase is reported.

Digital Payments and Fintech

On 3 August MVola's new director general [gave the first account of the platform migration behind the outages of May and June](#). The core platform was replaced in May 2026; he states that money does not vanish from accounts, that reported cases have been regularised, and that the platform is stabilised with further work outstanding. No regulator is named, no incident report is published and no compensation is mentioned. Separately, [Airtel Money integrated Baobab Bank into its mobile banking service on 17 July](#).

Registries

The day after the biometric-registration review, the electoral commission [opened a full reconstitution of the electoral roll at Talata Volonondry](#) — a rebuild rather than the routine revision — running four months to 24 November 2026, to produce the single roll for all elections and referendums scheduled in 2027. The trigger is stated: the previous roll drew sustained contestation and is named as a source of tension at earlier polls. Registration runs through five channels, at fokontany level on presentation of a national identity card. The commission states that an unregistered citizen may not observe polling in their own place of residence and may not lodge a complaint or contest results.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

On 28 July the national police [presented a free public reporting platform at Anosy](#), six days after the national day of mourning of 24 July that followed a run of kidnappings and killings. Built by the police's own information-systems directorate, it runs 24 hours a day on web and an Android application in Malagasy and French, taking reports of gender-based violence and of disappearances of children, adults and people with albinism. Reports may be filed anonymously, an automatically generated reference number lets a declarant track the file, and reports are triaged by specialist services before routing. Its scope is [explicitly digital](#): online harassment, non-consensual image sharing, sextortion, online defamation and AI-falsified content are reportable categories in their own right. No data controller, retention rule or supervisory authority is named.

On 3 August the higher-education ministry [presented an accreditation platform](#) centralising applications for authorisation, accreditation and equivalence and letting an institution track its file. It published its queue with it: 546 applications as at 10 July 2026, of which about 250 are expected at the commission session opening on 21 September 2026.

Two further builds are financed rather than delivered. The Maritime Single Window, centralising port administrative procedures, is [being deployed on more than 3.4bn Indonesian rupiah, about 816m ariary, from Indonesia's international development agency](#) through the port, maritime and river agency; no go-live date, port coverage or procedure list is stated. And the social-protection fund is [recruiting a consultancy to build a human-resources management ERP under a World Bank-financed project, bids due 26 August](#), having separately tendered on 7 August for a payroll server under a World Bank contingent emergency response project. Neither tender discloses a value.

Technology

AI

AXIAN Telecom was [named a founding partner of an African-language artificial-intelligence initiative on 28 July 2026](#). No Malagasy-language model or dataset has been released.

[A Madagascar-Egypt government partnership on the use of artificial intelligence in public administration and the sector's digital transition was reported on 1 August](#), with no date of signature given.

Capacity

Training and skills

The digital ministry [received 259 applications by 1 August 2026 for ten established civil-service posts](#), split between the capital and the regional directorates. The fields are artificial intelligence, data management, digital innovation, cybersecurity, telecommunications and digital law, the last covering personal data protection and electronic commerce. Applicants have publicly asked for integrity guarantees on the selection, and no appointment has been announced.

Inclusion

Access to services

The month's only market measurement came from an operator: MVola's director general put the whole Malagasy mobile-money market at [six to seven million active users against a population of about thirty million, with rural areas under-served](#), and set doubling or tripling that as the five-to-ten-year test.

Data

National statistics

The statistics institute runs a [registration-gated platform advertising household surveys for 2020 to 2022, an enterprise survey and census microdata](#). The datasets sit behind account registration and were not retrieved, so no dataset documentation, sample size, licence or reuse terms is established beyond the landing page.

Open data

Madagascar's open data is institution-specific and has no policy over it. The National Assembly runs a [read-only interface serving five parliamentary datasets as JSON and CSV under an open licence, rate-limited to 60 requests a minute, its counters reading 163 deputies, 45 texts and 128 sittings](#). Against that, a [general portal is a reachable landing page with six undated category tiles and four unlinked project cards, naming no issuing institution, dataset count or licence, and credited in its footer only to a private vendor](#); the finance ministry's own portal does not resolve. No whole-of-government open-data policy or mandate is held.

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